

scripts/hooks/action-prefix-expand.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-07-26 (LVA-018 script-docs backfill cycle)

Inheritance: HelixConstitution §11.4.140 (action-prefix mandate), §11.4.109 (anti-forgetting), §11.4.35 (canonical root), §11.4.28 (decoupling), §11.4.18 (script docs); Lava §6.AI / §6.AJ

Classification: project-specific (the .claude/ wiring is Lava's; the expander it delegates to is universal, inherited from the constitution submodule)

Overview

A Claude Code UserPromptSubmit hook — LAYER 2 of the universal ACTION_NAME :: prompt-prefix system. It is **thin Lava-side glue**: it does NOT reimplement the expander, it delegates to the canonical expander shipped by the pinned constitution submodule at constitution/scripts/hooks/action_prefix_expand.sh, which reads the action registry at constitution/actions/registry.yaml (or the \$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY override) and emits the additionalContext JSON for a registered action prefix.

Per the Decoupled Reusable Architecture rule this wrapper is the Lava-domain glue tying the submodule into Lava's .claude/ wiring; per §6.AD the submodule is pinned and its tracked files are never edited Lava-side.

Contract (Claude Code UserPromptSubmit hook)

- Receives the event JSON on **stdin** (the user's prompt at .prompt).
- **Exit 0 + JSON body** {"hookSpecificOutput": {"hookEventName": "UserPromptSubmit", "additionalContext": "<text>"} } → adds <text> to the conversation context (the action expansion).
- **Exit 0 + EMPTY stdout** → no-op (prompt passes through unchanged).
- The delegate **fails open**: any internal error degrades to pass-through, never blocks the prompt. This wrapper preserves that — a missing or non-executable delegate (e.g. submodule not

checked out) is a clean pass-through with a one-line stderr note.

Behaviour (delegated verbatim to the constitution expander)

Input shape	Result
Registered action (BACKGROUND :: x, /BACKGROUND x, namespaced forms)	Inject the registered expansion + rules
Unknown grammar-shaped token	Inject a §11.4.66/§11.4.105 clarify note (never invent an expansion, §11.4.6)
Normal prompt / escaped \PREFIX	Empty stdout (no-op)

Inputs

- stdin — UserPromptSubmit event JSON.
- CLAUDE_PROJECT_DIR (set by Claude Code) — repo root; the constitution submodule lives at \$CLAUDE_PROJECT_DIR/constitution/.
- HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY (optional) — registry path override, passed through.
- LAVA_ACTION_PREFIX_EXPANDER (optional) — delegate path override, used by the hermetic test to point at the canonical expander without relying on CLAUDE_PROJECT_DIR.

Delegate resolution order: LAVA_ACTION_PREFIX_EXPANDER → CLAUDE_PROJECT_DIR → this script's own location (scripts/hooks/ → repo root → constitution/).

Side effects

None. Read-only (reads the registry, reads stdin). Fail-open by design.

Usage / manual testing

```
# Registered action → additionalContext JSON on stdout
printf '%s' '{"prompt":"BACKGROUND :: run the bluff hunt"}' \
| bash scripts/hooks/action-prefix-expand.sh
```

```
# Normal prompt → empty stdout (pass-through)
```

```
printf '%s' '{"prompt":"hello"}' \  
| bash scripts/hooks/action-prefix-expand.sh
```

Dependencies

constitution/scripts/hooks/action_prefix_expand.sh (+ its sibling constitution/scripts/action_prefix_lib.sh). jq preferred, awk fallback (the delegate handles both).

Cross-references

- Lava CLAUDE.md §6.AI (HelixConstitution §11.4.128–141 adoption), §6.AI-debt item (1) (this wiring), §6.AJ (LAYER-1 recognition text)
- HelixConstitution §11.4.140 (action-prefix mandate), §11.4.109 (anti-forgetting), §11.4.35 (canonical root), §11.4.28 (decoupling)
- docs/scripts/hooks/guard-forbidden-commands.sh.md — the sibling PreToolUse hook (the other half of the mechanical-guard floor)